قصص الأنبياء

Stories of the Prophets

BOOK ONE

From Adam to Ibrahim

Written by Abu Zayd

This book belongs to

Write your name on the line

هٰذَا الْكِتَابُ مِلْكُ

Stories of the Prophets, Book One: From Adam to Ibrahim

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The Qur'anic verses are shown in Arabic. The English meanings are simplified for young readers and are not a full translation. For study, please use a complete translation and learn from a qualified teacher.

Out of love and respect, no prophet is drawn in this book.

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Published by Al Jannah Publications. First edition 2026.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

In the name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful

For Parents and Teachers

This book tells six stories from the Qur'an, from Prophet Adam to Prophet Ibrahim, peace be upon them, in simple words for children aged 5 to 10.

Out of love and respect, no prophet is drawn in this book. The pictures show the world around each story instead.

Each story ends with a lesson and a question to talk about together. Short ayahs are shown in Arabic with a simple English meaning. A few details come from the tradition of tafsir; these are marked "It is said" or "Many scholars say".

When you read a prophet's name, help your child say **'alayhis-salam**: peace be upon him.

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CHAPTER ONE

Prophet Adam

Made from clay

PROPHET ADAM عليه السلام

Made from Clay

Long, long ago, before there were any people, Allah created the angels from light.

Then Allah decided to make someone new: a person who would live on the earth and look after it. Allah took clay from the earth, shaped it, and gave it life. This was Adam, the very first human.

Allah taught Adam the names of all things. He knew things that even the angels did not know!

PROPHET ADAM عليه السلام

The One Who Said No

Allah told the angels to bow down to Adam to honour him. Every angel bowed straight away.

But Iblis, who was made from fire, stood tall and refused. “I am better than him,” he said. “You made me from fire and him from clay.”

Iblis was proud, and his pride made him disobey Allah. From that day he became Shaytan, the enemy who tries to trick people into doing wrong.

PROPHET ADAM عليه السلام

The Beautiful Garden

Allah gave Adam a wife, Hawwa, so he would not be lonely. They lived in Jannah, a garden more beautiful than anything we can imagine, full of rivers, fruit and peace.

Allah said: “Eat whatever you like, but do not go near this one tree.”

Shaytan whispered again and again: “Eat from it, and you will live forever!” At last, Adam and Hawwa forgot Allah’s warning and ate from the tree.

PROPHET ADAM عليه السلام

Saying Sorry

At once they felt very sad, because they had disobeyed Allah. Instead of making excuses, they turned to Allah and said sorry with all their hearts:

رَبَّنَا ظَلَمْنَا أَنفُسَنَا وَإِن لَّمْ تَغْفِرْ لَنَا وَتَرْحَمْنَا لَنَكُونَنَّ مِنَ الْخَاسِرِينَ

"Our Lord, we have wronged ourselves. If You do not forgive us and have mercy on us, we will surely be among the losers."

Surah Al-A'raf 7:23

Allah, the Most Forgiving, forgave them. Then He sent them down to live on the earth, where Adam became the father of all people and the very first prophet.

What We Learn

Everyone makes mistakes. Iblis was too proud to say sorry, but Adam said sorry straight away. When we do something wrong, we say sorry to Allah and to anyone we have hurt.

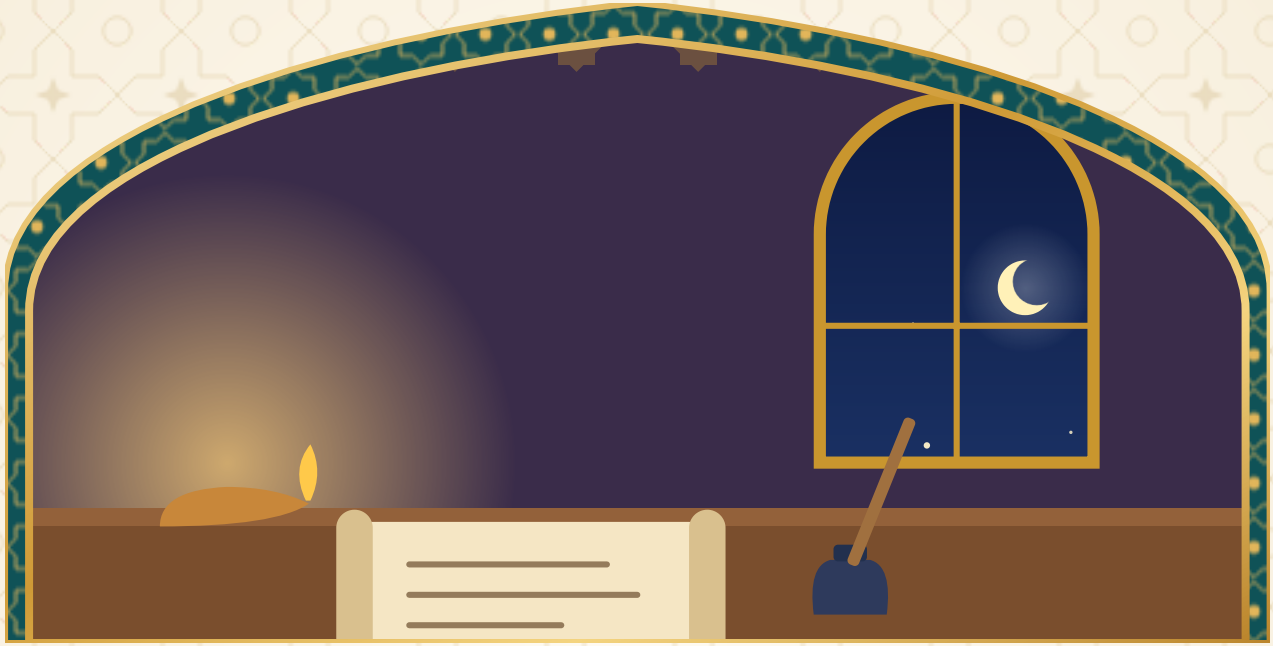
Talk together

Can you remember a time you said sorry? How did you feel afterwards?

CHAPTER TWO

Prophet Idris

The truthful teacher



PROPHET IDRIS عليه السلام

The Truthful Teacher

Many years after Adam, the families of the earth grew bigger and bigger. Allah sent Prophet Idris to guide them.

The Qur'an tells us that Idris always told the truth and was very patient. Many scholars say he was one of the first people to write with a pen.

He loved learning, and he taught people to remember Allah and to be fair to one another.

وَاذْكُرْ فِي الْكِتَابِ إِدْرِيسَ ۚ إِنَّهُ كَانَ صِدِّيقًا نَّبِيًّا

"And mention in the Book, Idris. He was a man of truth and a prophet."

Surah Maryam 19:56

PROPHET IDRIS عليه السلام

Raised to a High Place

It is said that Idris also taught people useful skills, like sewing clothes from cloth.

Idris worked hard, worshipped Allah and never stopped doing good. Allah loved him and says in the Qur'an: "We raised him to a high place." (19:57)

What We Learn

Learning is a gift from Allah. When we read, write and learn new things, and use them to help others, Allah is pleased with us.

Talk together

What is something new you would like to learn this year?

CHAPTER THREE

Prophet Nuh

The great ark

PROPHET NUH عليه السلام

950 Years of Calling

After a long time, people forgot what the prophets had taught. They carved statues out of stone and began to pray to them.

Allah sent Prophet Nuh to remind them: “Worship Allah alone. He made you and He cares for you.”

Nuh called them in the day and in the night, quietly and out loud, for 950 years! But most people put their fingers in their ears and walked away. Only a few believed.

PROPHET NUH عليه السلام

A Boat on Dry Land

Allah told Nuh to build an ark, a huge wooden boat. So Nuh began to cut wood and hammer planks, far away from any sea.

The people laughed at him. “Look! Nuh is building a boat on dry land!”

Nuh did not get angry and he did not give up. He trusted Allah and kept on building, one plank at a time.

PROPHET NUH عليه السلام

Two by Two

When the ark was ready, Allah's command came. Nuh gathered a pair of every kind of animal, a male and a female, and the believers came aboard too.

As they climbed in, Nuh said:

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ مَجْرَاهَا وَمُرْسَاهَا ۚ إِنَّ رَبِّي لَغَفُورٌ رَّحِيمٌ

"In the name of Allah it sails and it comes to rest. My Lord is Forgiving and Merciful."

Surah Hud 11:41

PROPHET NUH عليه السلام

Waves Like Mountains

Rain poured down from the sky and water burst up from the ground. The ark sailed on waves as big as mountains.

Nuh saw his own son standing apart and called, “My son, come with us!” But his son said, “I will climb a mountain to keep safe.”

Nuh said, “Today nothing can save anyone except Allah’s mercy.” A wave came between them. Only those who believed were safe in the ark.

PROPHET NUH عليه السلام

Resting on Al-Judi

At last Allah commanded: “O earth, swallow your water! O sky, hold back your rain!”

The water went down, and the ark came to rest on Mount Al-Judi. Nuh, the believers and all the animals stepped out onto a fresh, clean earth and thanked Allah.

What We Learn

GOOD MANNER

Patience and trust

Nuh was patient for a very long time, and he kept trusting Allah even when people laughed at him. When something is hard, we keep going, keep doing what is right, and trust Allah.

Talk together

Which animals do you think were on the ark? What was the hardest part for Nuh?

CHAPTER FOUR

Prophet Hud

The proud people of ʻAd

PROPHET HUD عليه السلام

The Strongest People

Far away among the sand dunes of Al-Ahqaf lived the people of ‘Ad. They were very tall and very strong.

They built tall buildings with giant pillars, and Allah gave them gardens, cattle and springs of water.

But instead of thanking Allah, they became proud. “Who is stronger than us?” they boasted.

PROPHET HUD عليه السلام

Be Thankful

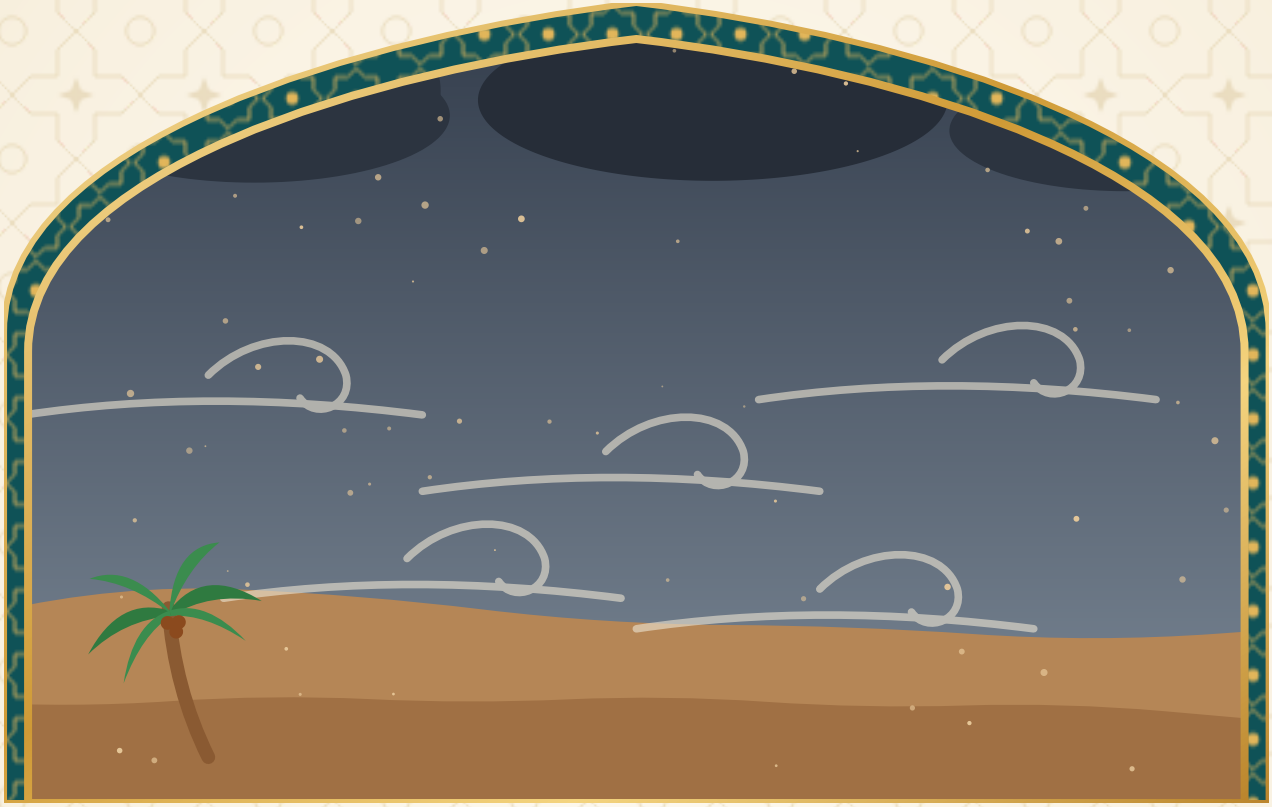
Allah sent them one of their own brothers, Prophet Hud. He spoke to them kindly:

وَيَا قَوْمِ اسْتَغْفِرُوا رَبَّكُمْ ثُمَّ تُوبُوا إِلَيْهِ يُرْسِلِ السَّمَاءَ عَلَيْكُم مِّدْرَارًا

"O my people, ask your Lord to forgive you and turn back to Him. He will send you plenty of rain from the sky."

Surah Hud 11:52

But the people only laughed. "Our gods have made you crazy, Hud!" Hud was not afraid, because he trusted Allah. Soon the rain stopped, and the land became dry.



PROPHET HUD عليه السلام

The Cloud That Was Not Rain

One day a huge, dark cloud came toward them. “Rain is coming!” they cheered.

But it was not rain. It was a fierce, freezing wind that blew for seven nights and eight days, and the proud people of ‘Ad were gone.

Allah saved Hud and the believers with His mercy.

What We Learn

Everything we have, our strength, our homes and our food, comes from Allah. Instead of showing off, we say “Alhamdulillah” and stay humble.

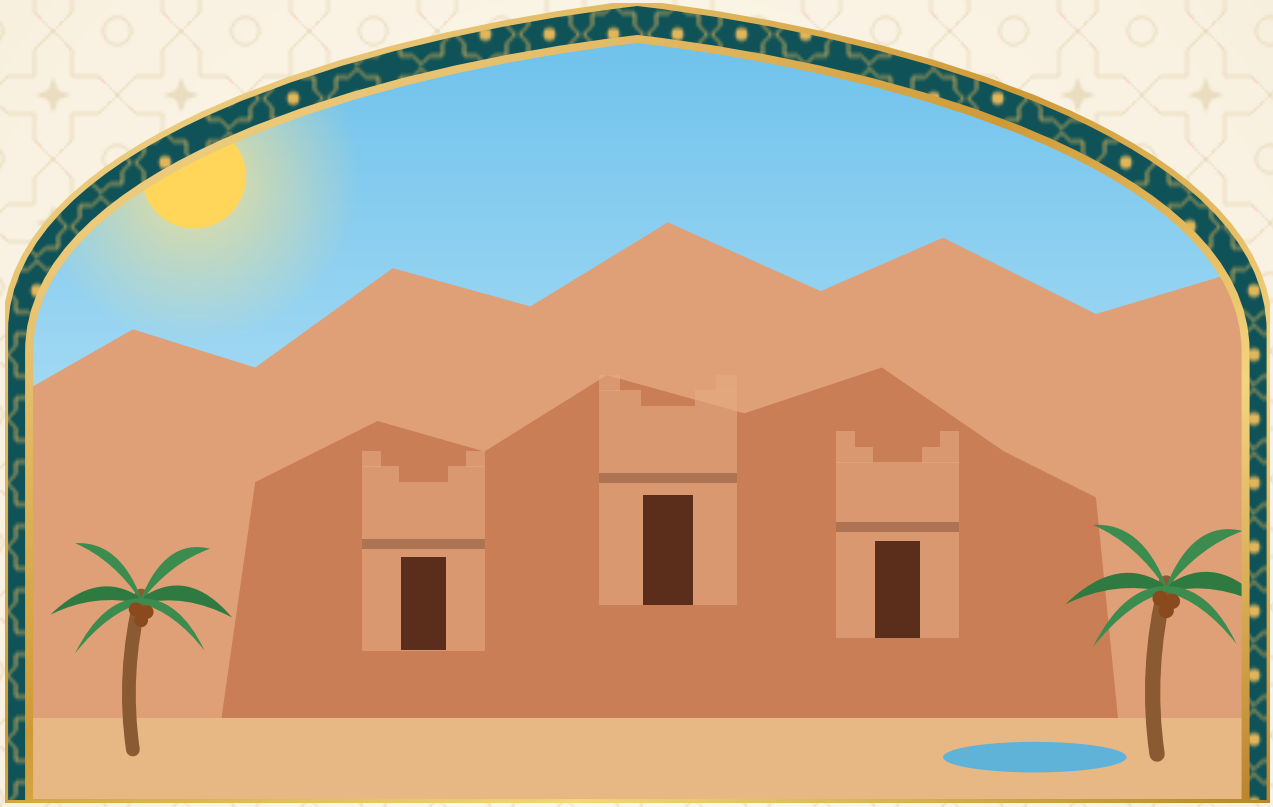
Talk together

Name three things you are thankful to Allah for today.

CHAPTER FIVE

Prophet Salih

The camel from the rock



PROPHET SALIH عليه السلام

Homes in the Mountains

After ‘Ad came the people of Thamud. They were clever builders who carved beautiful houses right into the rocky mountains.

They had palm trees, gardens and springs. But like the people before them, they worshipped idols and forgot Allah.

So Allah sent them Prophet Salih, a good and honest man whom they had always respected.

PROPHET SALIH عليه السلام

A Camel from the Rock

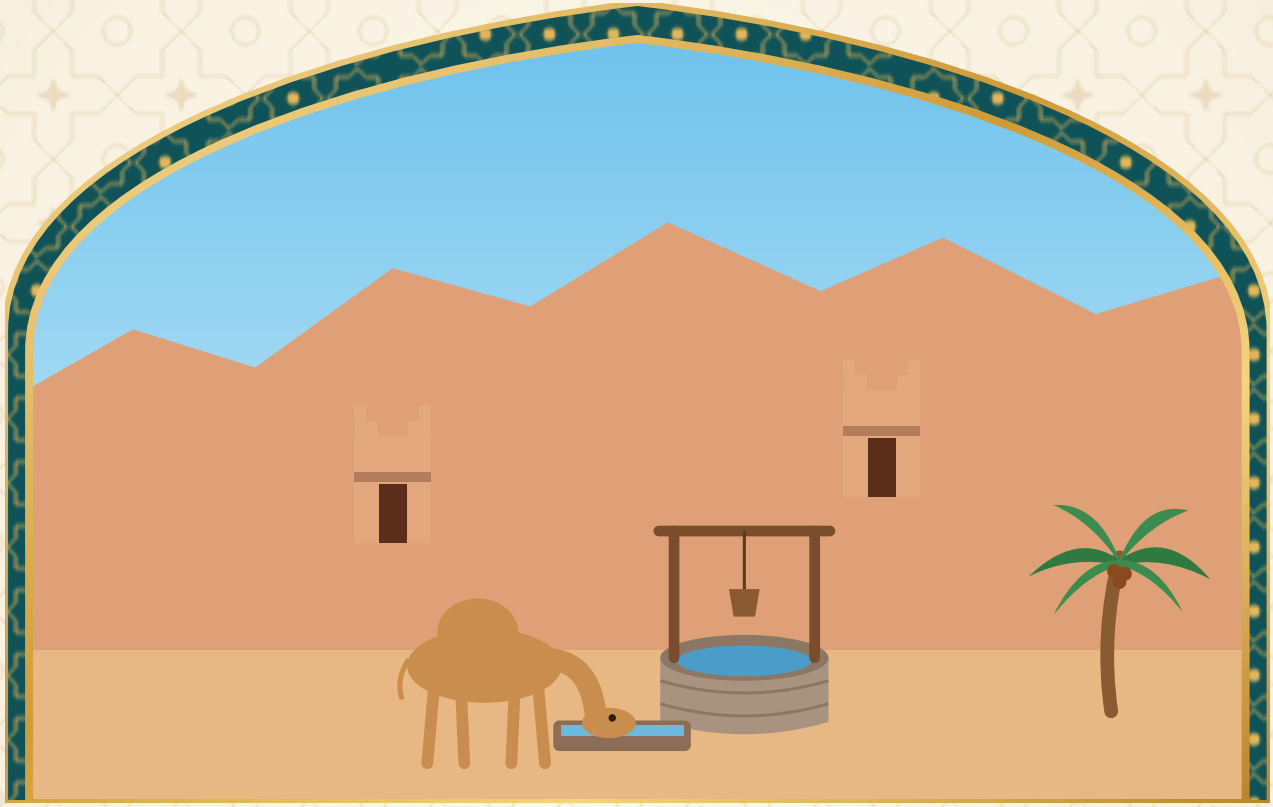
“Worship Allah alone,” Salih told them. The people said, “If you are really a prophet, bring us a miracle! Make a camel come out of that rock!”

Salih prayed to Allah, and the great rock split open. Out came a wonderful she-camel, a sign from Allah for everyone to see.

وَيَا قَوْمِ هَٰذِهِ نَاقَةُ اللَّهِ لَكُمْ آيَةً فَذَرُوهَا تَأْكُلْ فِي أَرْضِ اللَّهِ وَلَا تَمَسُّوهَا بِسُوءٍ

“O my people, this is the she-camel of Allah, a sign for you. Let her eat on Allah’s earth and do not harm her.”

Surah Hud 11:64



PROPHET SALIH عليه السلام

Sharing the Water

Salih gave them a rule from Allah: the camel would drink from the well one day, and the people would drink the next day.

“Do not harm her,” he warned, “or punishment will come.” The people promised.

It is said that on her day, the camel gave so much milk that there was enough for everyone!

PROPHET SALIH عليه السلام

A Broken Promise

But some unkind people did not want to share. They made a wicked plan, and they hurt the camel and killed her.

Salih said sadly: “Enjoy your homes for three days. Then Allah’s promise will come.”

After three days, a mighty blast shook the mountains, and the people who broke their promise were gone. Allah saved Salih and the believers.

What We Learn

GOOD MANNER

Keeping promises

A promise is a promise. Keep your word, share with others, and be gentle with animals, because they are Allah's creatures too.

Talk together

How could you be kind to an animal this week?

CHAPTER SIX

Prophet Ibrahim

The fire that was cool

PROPHET IBRAHIM عليه السلام

A Boy Who Wondered

In an old city, long ago, lived a boy named Ibrahim. His father, Azar, made statues out of stone and wood, and everyone in the city bowed down to them.

Ibrahim looked at the statues and wondered: “They cannot see. They cannot hear. They cannot help anyone. How can they be gods?”

PROPHET IBRAHIM عليه السلام

The Star, the Moon and the Sun

One night Ibrahim showed his people a shining star. “Is this my Lord?” But the star set and disappeared. “I do not love things that disappear,” he said.

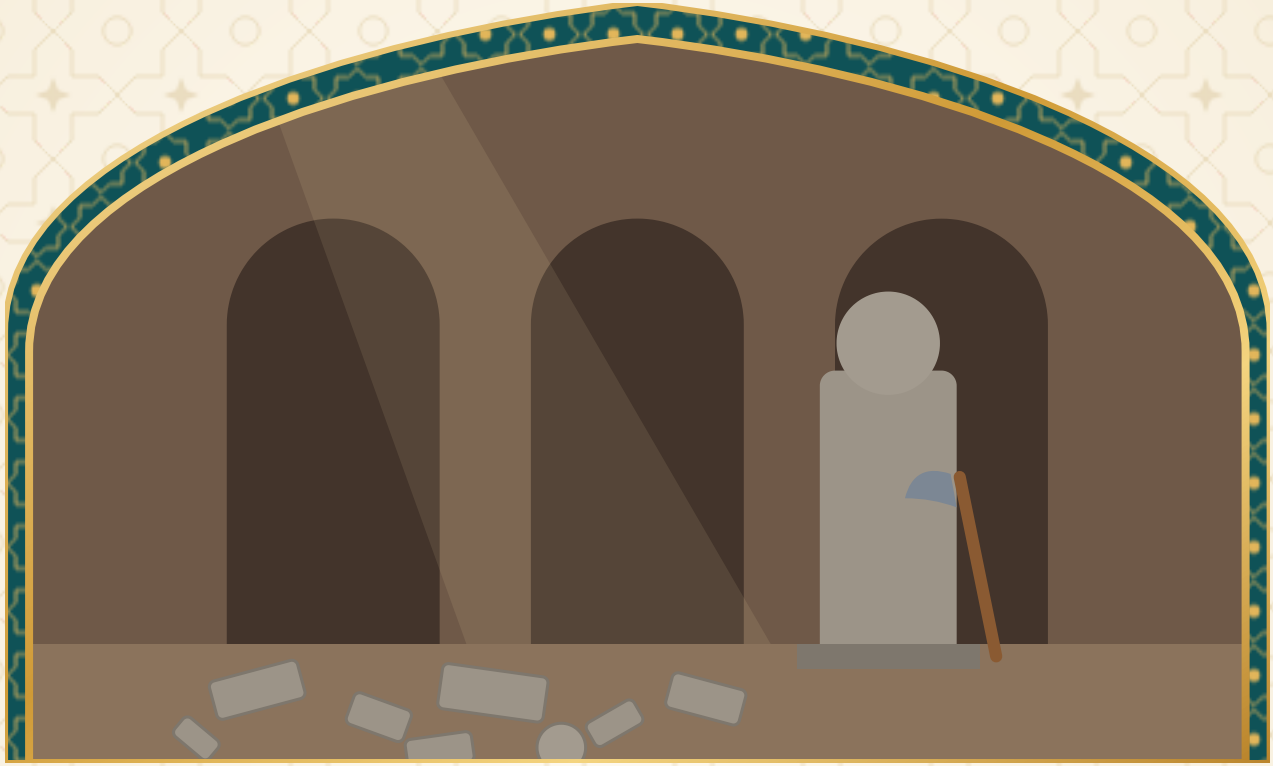
Then the bright moon rose, but it set too. In the morning the big, bright sun came up. “This is the biggest!” But by evening the sun also set.

Ibrahim said:

إِنِّي وَجَّهْتُ وَجْهِيَ لِلَّذِي فَطَرَ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ حَنِيفًا

“I have turned my face to the One who created the heavens and the earth.”

Surah Al-An‘am 6:79



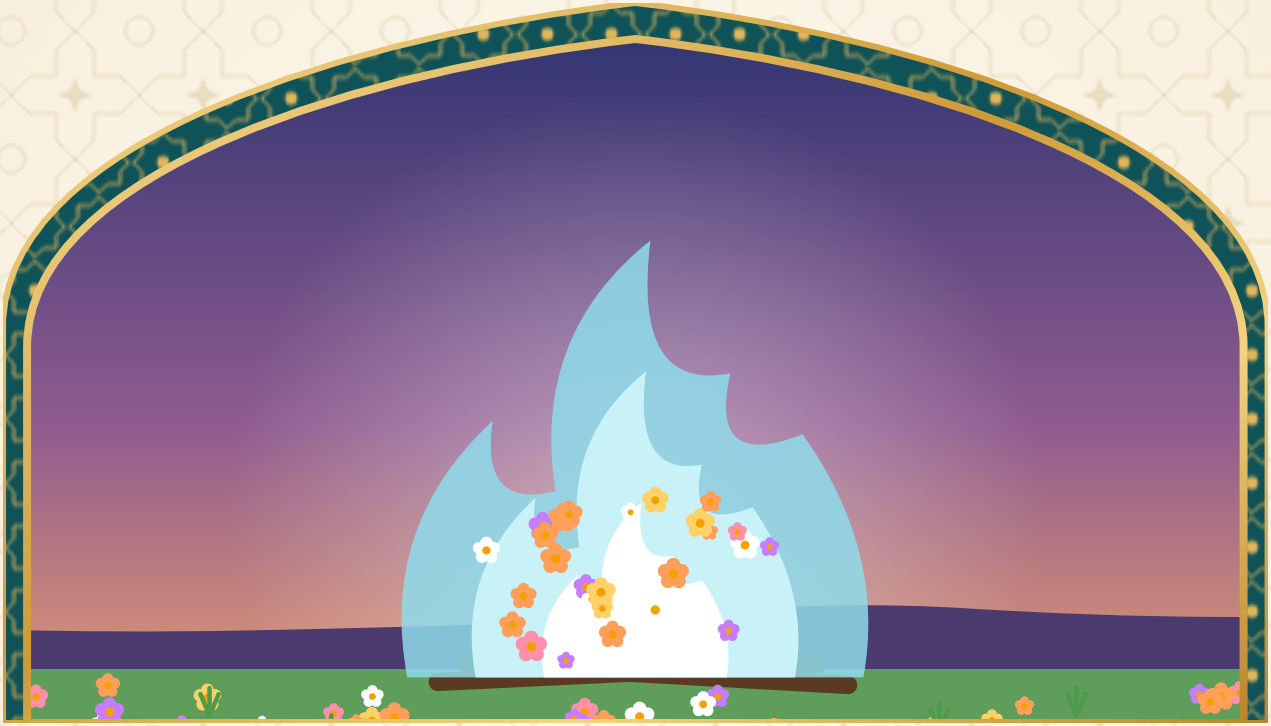
PROPHET IBRAHIM عليه السلام

Ask the Biggest One

One day, when everyone had gone out of the city for a festival, Ibrahim went into the temple. With an axe he broke all the statues, except the biggest one.

When the people came back they shouted, “Who did this?” Ibrahim said, “Why don’t you ask the big one, if they can speak?”

The people knew that statues cannot speak. For a moment they felt ashamed, but they were too proud to change.



PROPHET IBRAHIM عليه السلام

Cool and Safe

The angry people built a giant fire and threw Ibrahim into it. Ibrahim was not afraid. He trusted Allah completely.

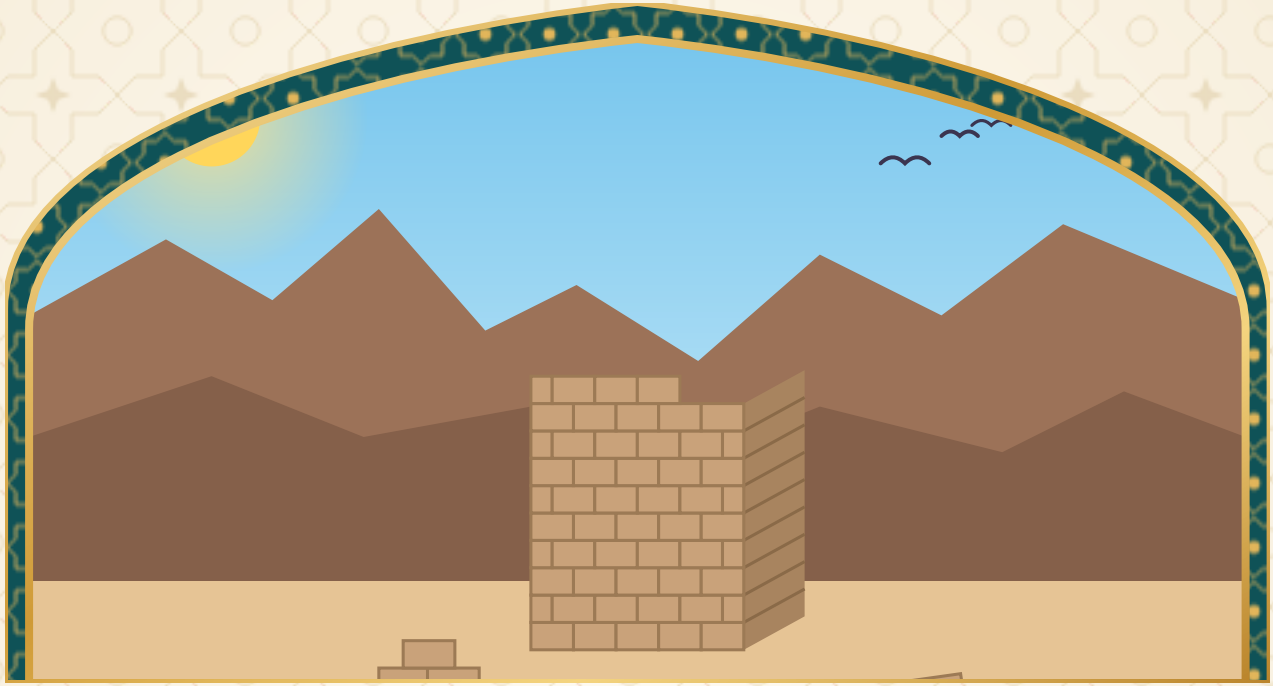
Allah commanded the fire:

يَا نَارُ كُونِي بَرْدًا وَسَلَامًا عَلَىٰٓ إِبْرَاهِيمَ

"O fire, be cool and safe for Ibrahim."

Surah Al-Anbiya 21:69

The fire did not hurt him at all. Ibrahim walked out safe and well.



PROPHET IBRAHIM عليه السلام

The House of Allah

Ibrahim was a very generous host. When guests came, he hurried to serve them a whole roasted calf. Allah called him Khalil, a close friend.

Later, with his son Ismail, Ibrahim built the Ka'bah in Makkah, a house for worshipping Allah alone. As they lifted the stones, they prayed:

رَبَّنَا تَقَبَّلْ مِنَّا ۖ إِنَّكَ أَنتَ السَّمِيعُ الْعَلِيمُ

"Our Lord, accept this from us. You are the All-Hearing, the All-Knowing."

Surah Al-Baqarah 2:127

Today Muslims all over the world face the Ka'bah when they pray.

What We Learn

Ibrahim used his mind to think, was brave enough to stand up for the truth, trusted Allah in the fire, and was generous to his guests. We can think, be brave, trust Allah and share too.

Talk together

When we pray, which way do we face? Who built it?

Story Quiz

Colour in the circle next to the right answer!

1. Who was the very first human?

○ Adam ○ Nuh ○ Hud

2. What did Adam do after his mistake?

○ Hid away ○ Said sorry to Allah ○ Blamed someone

3. Which prophet was one of the first to write with a pen?

○ Salih ○ Ibrahim ○ Idris

4. What did Nuh build?

○ A tower ○ An ark ○ A well

5. What did the people of 'Ad think the dark cloud was?

○ Rain ○ Snow ○ Birds

6. What came out of the rock for the people of Thamud?

○ A lion ○ A river ○ A she-camel

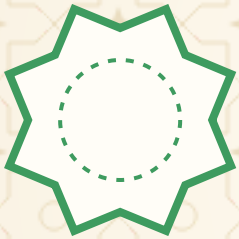
7. What did Allah tell the fire?

○ Burn brighter ○ Be cool and safe ○ Go away

Answers: 1. Adam · 2. Said sorry to Allah · 3. Idris · 4. An ark · 5. Rain · 6. A she-camel · 7. Be cool and safe

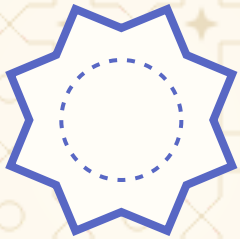
My Good Manners Stars

Colour in a star each time you practise a good manner.



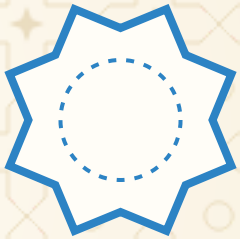
PROPHET ADAM

Saying sorry



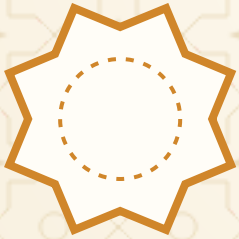
PROPHET IDRIS

Loving to learn



PROPHET NUH

Patience and trust

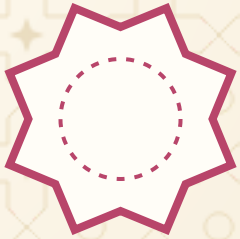


PROPHET HUD

Being thankful

PROPHET SALIH

Keeping promises



PROPHET IBRAHIM

Courage and trust

الحمد لله

The End

رَّبِّ زِدْنِي عِلْمًا

“My Lord, increase me in knowledge.”

Surah Ta-Ha 20:114